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**V**arun Sanyal's father wasn't particularly thrilled four years ago when he learned what his son wanted to do with his life.

The then 23-year-old had just graduated from Queen Mary University of London in England with a first-class honours degree in business. His father, an economist and Member of Prime Minister Narendra Modi's Economic Advisory Council, had every reason to believe his son had a conventional, well-paying career in finance ahead of him.

Instead, Varun wanted to fight.

"I told him I wanted to become a mixed martial arts fighter. He wasn't too thrilled that I wanted to pivot away from my business degree," Varun tells *Sportstar*. "I even graduated with a first-class honours degree, so things were looking good. And suddenly, I've decided to go into this."

His father's reservations were less about sport itself than the uncertainty and physical risks of

# THE FIGHT IS HIS OWN

**Varun Sanyal** chose MMA over a career in finance. Now, the Asian Games-bound fighter is determined to earn his own reputation, away from his father's shadow.

